PassFrame
TUITION

# The Boy Who Collected Clouds

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

## Extract — read it carefully before answering

Theo did not collect stamps or marbles like the other boys in his class. Theo collected clouds — or rather, he collected words for them, scribbled into a battered green notebook he carried everywhere he went.

'Today,' he wrote, lying flat on his back in the school field, 'a cloud shaped exactly like a galloping horse, with a mane of wispy white threads trailing behind it.' Beside him, his notebook flapped gently in the breeze, pages soft from being turned so many times.

Some of the other children laughed when they saw him staring up at the sky instead of playing football. 'What's the point of writing about clouds?' sneered Marcus from Year 5. 'They just float away and disappear.'

Theo didn't have an answer that day, but that evening his grandmother found him curled up on the sofa, flicking through his notebook with a troubled frown. 'Everything beautiful floats away eventually,' she said gently, settling beside him. 'That's exactly why it's worth writing down.'

Theo thought about this for a long time. The next morning, he returned to the school field with his notebook as always — only now, when Marcus asked his question again, Theo simply smiled and said, 'That's exactly the point.'

## Questions

*20 min · 12 questions*

**1.** What did Theo collect, instead of stamps or marbles like other boys?

**2.** What shape did the cloud Theo described in the field look like?

**3.** Underline the sentence that tells you Theo's notebook had been used a great deal.

**4.** Underline the sentence that shows Marcus thought Theo's hobby was pointless.

**5.** What does “sneered” tell you about the way Marcus spoke to Theo?

**6.** True or false: Theo had a confident answer for Marcus straight away.

**7.** Why do you think Theo's grandmother said “everything beautiful floats away eventually”?

**8.** Who helped Theo understand why his hobby was worthwhile?

**9.** In your own words, explain what Theo's grandmother meant by her comment.

**10.** What does Theo's smile at the end of the extract suggest about how he was feeling?

**11.** Why do you think the author chose clouds, rather than something more permanent, for Theo to collect?

**12.** Do you agree with Theo's grandmother's view? Explain your own opinion.